

Sponsored Display Setup Guide

Targeting types, setup steps, and how to judge SD performance without holding it to Sponsored Products' bar.

What Sponsored Display is

Sponsored Display (SD) is Amazon's remarketing and interest-based display format — it shows a banner-style ad both on and off Amazon, targeting shoppers by what they've viewed, what products they're similar to, or broad audience interests rather than by search keyword. It's the format for staying in front of a shopper after they've left without buying.

Eligibility

- A Professional seller account or vendor account with an active listing.
- No Brand Registry requirement for product targeting; some audience options are Brand-Registry-only.

Targeting types

Type	How it targets	Best for
Product targeting — your catalog	Shows your ad on your own product pages	Cross-selling within your own catalog
Product targeting — competitors	Shows your ad on similar/competing product pages	Winning consideration at the moment a shopper compares
Views remarketing	Retargets shoppers who viewed your product but didn't buy	Recovering abandoned consideration, usually within 30 days
Purchases remarketing	Retargets past buyers of your product or related products	Repeat purchase or complementary-product upsell
Audiences (lifestyle/interest)	Broad in-market or lifestyle segments Amazon defines	Top-of-funnel awareness for new-to-brand shoppers

Setup, step by step

- 1 In Campaign Manager, choose Sponsored Display, then pick a targeting type from the table above based on your goal (cross-sell, win-back, or awareness).
- 2 For product targeting, add specific ASINs or categories; for audiences, pick from Amazon's predefined segments — SD doesn't support freeform keyword targeting.
- 3 Choose or upload creative — SD can auto-generate a banner from your listing images, or you can upload a custom creative for more control over the message.
- 4 Set bid strategy: Dynamic bids (down only) is the safer default for a first campaign; Dynamic bids (up and down) increases bids automatically in high-conversion-probability auctions once you have performance data to trust.
- 5 Set a daily budget and launch. SD creative review is typically faster than Sponsored Brands but still isn't instant.

Best practices

- Start with views remarketing on your best sellers — it's usually the highest-converting SD targeting type because the shopper has already shown direct intent.
- Keep competitor product targeting on ASINs genuinely comparable to yours — targeting a wildly different price tier just burns impressions.
- Separate campaigns by targeting type (remarketing vs. audiences vs. product targeting) rather than mixing them in one campaign — they convert very differently and need separate budgets to read performance clearly.
- Give SD at least 2–3 weeks before judging ACOS; it's a slower-converting, higher-funnel format than Sponsored Products and shouldn't be held to the same same-day conversion bar.

Common mistakes

- Judging SD by same-day ACOS the way you would Sponsored Products — its role is often assisted conversion further down the path, not the last click.
- Leaving Dynamic bids (up and down) on from day one, before there's enough conversion data for Amazon's system to bid up correctly.
- Never refreshing creative — a stale, low-CTR banner keeps losing auctions to fresher competitor creative.

SD targeting options and available audience segments vary by marketplace and account eligibility — confirm what's available in your account before planning a campaign around a specific segment.

Project Amazon PH Academy — Download Center. Educational reference material; verify against current Amazon Ads policy and your account's own data before acting.